My name is Jiawei Wang, I am 33 years old and I am a Chinese citizen. I moved to Rock Hill, South Carolina in early 2026.

Before that, I spent my youth in Hefei, China with my parents as their only child. I earned a bachelor's degree in medicine from Anhui Medical University, and spent some time in Japan pursuing a postgraduate degree, but eventually I decided to come to the US on August 15, 2019.

Before 2026, I earned a master's degree in engineering from Tufts University in Medford, Massachusetts, worked for Amazon as a software engineer in Seattle, Washington. Then I moved to Charlotte, North Caroline to work for Intuit Credit Karma, and later Microsoft.

I met Paige Meinke in November 2025, and I was let go from my Microsoft engineering job in December 2025.

My life was turned outside down in a span of 12 months. I lost my job, I lost my work visa and my legal status, I lost income and access to health care. I tried so incredibly hard to apply to jobs, to extend my visa, to build my relationship with Paige and our life together. I lived with Paige at her residence in Rock Hill, South Carolina between February and October 2026.

In September and October 2026, three events destroyed me completely.

- Paige and I got into 3 arguments and she decided to break up with me.
- I was hospitalized for 14 hours for suicidal statements Paige reported to the police.
- I was arrested and taken into jail for 22 hours for a petty larceny charge Paige pressed against me.

I lost everything in my life, and I lost all my will to live.

This is a letter I wrote to explain my suicide, to say goodbye and apologize to everyone that loves me and cares for me.

It contains 3 parts, the first part was written after the breakup between late September and early October, the second part was written after I was discharged from the hospital on October 15th, and the last part was written after I was released from jail on bond on October 26th. There are some discrepancies between these parts, please use later parts as my true final wishes.

The next page was written for the safety of my dog, it was printed out and put near my body for first responders to read. If you are reading this letter through a device, then hopefully, they have already properly handled my body and taken my dog to a safe place.

Suicide Note

PLZ DO NOT HURT THE DOG!

This is a quite long letter so after you find my body and this letter, before you jump into reading the whole letter.
First thing first:

1. The white/tan Chihuahua/Dachshund mix dog barking at you means you no harm, she is just scared.
2. Her name is Chica, a rescue from Everett Animal Shelter in Washington, and she is about 7 years old. Call Kevin Melkonyan at 702-338-2646, or Nicklas Jensen at 980-701-1780, or Paws In The Panhandle 803-431-4075, they will come and take care of Chica for the day.

Part 1: this part was written after the breakup in September and before my hospitalization on October 14.

Hi!

If you are reading this letter, that means I, Wang Jiawei, have already committed suicide and my body is nearby. This letter was originally written for the closest people in my life to read: My mom Gao Jinhua, my dad Wang Wenqiu, my close family members in China, my now ex-girlfriend Paige Meinke, and my forever best friend Nicklas Jensen, and my greatest companion Chica. Chica is a dog so she can't read the letter, but please let her know that I loved her everyday from the moment I met her to the end of my life.

But I understand very likely you are not one of them, you are a first responder, a police officer, a lawyer, a judge, etc. For everyone to read with ease and for legal matters, I decided to write this whole letter in English, although it is not my mother tone, and I feel deeply saddened that even at the very last moment of my life, I could neither fall into eternal sleep in the warming arms of my homeland, nor write this letter in my mother tone to share my emotions and regrets and appreciation of life.

This letter contains detailed information of many of my important life events, some of them were kept as a secret and never shared with others, it is impossible for anyone other than myself to write this letter, to further prove these are indeed my own words and my true last wishes, I also have digital copies stored on my computer and cloud, and signed my name at the bottom of each page for the physical copy. To the authority that has legal power to conduct search and investigation: the pin to unlock my MacBook is 6520, you should find this exact letter inside the Download folder, it is also stored on my Google Drive with title "Farewell", and I currently intend to upload it to the shared GitHub repo between Paige and me. But I wish my privacy to be respected as she should be the only person having sole right to access and distribute this letter from that repo. As I am writing this part down, I have not yet finished the whole letter so I have not yet decided how I will conduct my suicide and where my body and this letter will be found.

This suicide decision was not made easily. This decision was made through weeks of reflecting and thinking, as this letter was also written in a span of multiple weeks. My life had taken a free fall since 2026 and I was living in literal hell everyday for the whole September and October. My body and my mind had been pushed way over the limit and the damages were too great and the pain was too much to handle.

In this letter, I want to share with you what happened to me in 2026, how the past years of my life were, my self reflections and last words with each of the most important

people in my life, and lastly how I wish my body to be handled and my assets to be distributed.

2026 was a beautiful and cruel year.

I met Paige Meinke in November 2025, we clicked immediately after a great conversation on a dating app. We had our first date at a Vietnamese coffee shop, she was easily the most beautiful girl I had ever seen. She was a conversationalist with a great sense of humor and an open mind. We talked for hours and found we had so much in common. Five days later after a wonderful second date, she sat in my car and looked me in the eyes: “Do you want to kiss in the backseat?” and that’s when I asked her to be my girlfriend.

Life was great with Paige in it. At that time I was navigating through a lot of stressful situations: Coworkers on my team at Microsoft had been let go left and right for multiple months, I was not enjoying my relationship with my manager, and I had been spending great effort into external job hunting after work. My job at Microsoft was not worth saving so I made a gamble with my career. However, preparing for an interview with a dream company on the other side of the country while working full time for a team that had employees leaving every week was not an easy task.

Luckily I had Nathan Klinge, my great tennis partner, my soon-to-be landlord and roommate. Nathan invited me to visit him in his newly purchased house in northeast Charlotte after I finished an unpleasant living experience with my last apartment and expressed my anxiety of job uncertainty to him. Fortunately Nathan is a caring person with a tender heart. After hanging out for some Chinese food after tennis, he invited me to live with him and I accepted his offer. Before Paige came into my life, he was my biggest supporter and brought so much joy into my stressed daily life. He loved Chica as much as I did. He walked Chica, fed Chica, played with Chica and let Chica sleep on his lap during that winter. He treated Chica and me like family.

December was a hell of a rollercoaster. After not getting appreciated for my last project at Microsoft, I knew it was my turn to leave. I was let go after an HR ambush meeting and in the meantime, the Google interview I prepared for weeks ended with no offer. I was even matched with a hiring manager for his team but eventually I was not able to convince the hiring committee. It was the worst job market I had experienced, with my biggest chance for career leap lost, with my 60 day grace period counting down after Microsoft ended my H1b work visa sponsorship, and with not a single company processing applications during the end of year holiday season, Paige came to me and took me on a mystery trip. She bought tickets to fly us to Boston, the first city I ever

landed in in the US and my forever favorite city in the US, to celebrate my birthday with her, and to see Olivia Dean's live performance at TD Garden.

So Easy was the first song I sent to her after our first date.

My first time staying at her place in Rock Hill, I still remember how my heart was pumping faster and faster the closer I approached her place. When the car finally parked in front of her driveway, I had to take deep breaths to calm myself down. Paige owns a lovely house and she showed me all the artistic, niche, and weird things around each room. We spent that night laying in her guest bedroom exchanging heartfelt little words and giggles. "I am committed", that was my promise.

60 days passed quickly, everyday I lived like a robot. I got up, jumped right into applying for jobs, then it was responding to recruiter emails, grinding coding interview questions and hoping some positive feedback would come soon.

Everyday I would tell Paige how much I love her and how much I wish I could have a job that lets me stay with her in the same city, how much time I would sacrifice and how long a commute I would endure just to be with her. The job is in DC? No problem, I am willing to drive eight hours to come back every weekend. The job is in Pittsburgh? Then I am prepared to fly. But no, no one wanted me, I was so close in many of the last round interviews and I fell in front of the finish line countless times. And my H1b grace period was coming to an end.

I made another gamble, this time it is with my future. I saw a life where Paige and I could be together forever so after some thinking and conversations with Paige, a decision was made. I didn't pack up and leave the country like many of my peers who lost their jobs and consequently visas. In early February I decided to stay and applied for a Change of Status to B2 tourist visa to maintain my legal status. Hoping a 6 month extended stay would give me enough time to find an employer that is willing to pull me back onto H1b and bridge the gap. It did give me the time I wanted, and months later, it also gave me a surprise I would not even dream in my worst nightmare.

I left Nathan's place and moved in with Paige in February following my application for B2. I still remember that day when Paige helped me unload everything from the Uhaul truck and we placed them into places Paige had made for me prior to my arrival. We put my clothes in the wardrobe next to hers, we placed my computer desk in the library next to the chair so she could read next to me while I work. Our toothbrushes side by side in the same cup. It was my first time ever living with a partner and it went surprisingly well. Life tasted like sweet sweet chocolate with Paige in it. Everyday we cooked for each

other, we shared a lot of laughter together, we introduced each other to new hobbies and friend groups. Everyday for me was still stressful, I was still applying to many, many companies, receiving all kinds of rejections, always being on my toes preparing for the next recruiter call. Paige's presence eased my mind and freed my anxiety. She was eager to hear from me for my last interview's updates, she encouraged me to keep fighting, she was always there and always listening. I felt purpose, I felt that I could overcome all these difficulties and make things happen, I truly believed I could have a life with her here. I grinded for months, till reality hit me in June.

I was able to secure a job offer from Bain & Co after countless failed interviews in June. The salary did not stand out but they were supportive with all the visa sponsorship and were happy to let me travel to the office only once a week. Bain has many offices in the US so instead of relocating, I asked them to let me stay in Rock Hill with Paige and I would be willing to drive to the nearest office in Atlanta, they approved. Eight hours round trip, I did not even think much about that, because every obstacle is nothing compared to being able to have a life together with Paige. Bain moved forward with my sponsorship, and Paige and I celebrated this great news with our close family and friends. That was a brief moment, a moment I felt I finally could take full control of my life and sail for a bright future. It was a beautiful moment.

Reality hit me hard. A surprise meeting invite from my recruiter popped up in my inbox, I jumped onto the call. He informed me that the immigration law firm Fragomen working on my work visa transfer noticed that I was still having a pending B2 application I submitted in February along with an inactive H1b, and they shared this harsh reality:

Since the tech layoff in 2022, many people had used B2 as a solution to allow them to stay and do job hunting and keep the life that they built for years, till March 2026. In March, the immigration department archived their guidance on allowing H1b layoffs to change status to B2 with intention to apply for jobs and later switch back to H1b, they started to delay and deny cases, and my application was unfortunately impacted. Trump administration has been constantly creating blockers for legal immigrants to have more options when facing life uncertainties, and blocking H1b to B2 was one of them. My application became pending, a pending that never ended.

With a pending B2, the law firm was unwilling to file the petition to transfer my H1b to Bain citing high risk of B2 denial and subsequently low success in H1b petition, the recruiter brought this up with me and I was shocked. At that time I had already planned for everything, however the rescinded offer totally turned my life upside down.

Trying to find resources to persuade them to change their mind, I connected with my personal lawyer. “B2 bridging was totally doable in 2025 but I have not seen a single successful case yet in 2026.” He was a direct and honest lawyer, no sugarcoating at all. “I would leave the US asap before B2 is denied if I were you”.

I cried, Paige cried, I held her in my arms and told her how much I treasured the time we had together and despite all the difficulties, I still would try my absolute best to find a way to build our lives together. We spent days exploring options. I explored job opportunities in other countries with hope to transfer me back to the US with an L1 visa one year later, which at least still allows us to be in the same country and have a chance to visit each other. I considered taking on a long term job in another country, proposing to her when our relationship grows maturely and using a K1 Fiance visa to come back. She even proposed we do a courtroom wedding, although later we both decided that it would not be something we wanted to pursue, since I wanted her to only marry me when she genuinely felt ready and I wanted her to enjoy the once in a lifetime wedding experience that she deserves. Being rushed into a marriage for Green Card purposes would also make her life miserable.

I started to apply to all kinds of companies in every country, I applied like a crazy man, often I would apply to hundreds in a span of 10 hours and not do anything else for the rest of the day. I was too mentally drained by the end of the day and just wanted to relax in my own comfort zone. I stopped asking her about her daily work, I stopped asking her about her emotions and feelings, I stopped cooking and sitting down to eat with her, I stopped giving her the attention and physical touch she needed. I stopped being the good man that I used to be, the partner she needed.

Paige was going through a tough time at work as well, her company was going through lots of leadership changes and she started to leave home earlier and earlier each day and came back exhausted. But she was still showing me care and love, she asked me about my day, she asked me about how each conversation with the interviewer went, she asked me if I wanted to spend some time together at night. Often I would simply want to eat in front of my desk and watch some youtube videos to relax. So for many nights, she ate alone, she cleaned the kitchen and did the dishes alone, she sat on the couch in the living room watching tv alone at night and had no one to talk to. All because I felt my stress and my time and my emotions were more important than hers. Yes I was desperate for a job, yes I had exhausted all my financial resources, and yes my life was filled with uncertainties, but no, I had zero excuse to be a jerk and I had zero excuse to stop putting in efforts to care for her and our relationship.

She did all the hard work, both for our relationship and at her job. And she was still let go from her job because of downsizing. With both of us unemployed, we now had much more time each day to be with each other, but rather than having more intimacy, we got into more arguments. Oh how stupid I was that I argued with her on the least important things, and those arguments eventually cost me the most important person, my whole future and pushed me towards suicide.

The honeymoon period faded away with us having more time to be at home together. At first we were able to brush off the minor annoyances since we built a solid foundation for our relationship in the first half of the year, but once the stress mounted for both of us, those tiny flaws became sparks, and sparks became fire, leading to arguments that could have been completely avoided. We argued about trivial daily things, house chores, schedule conflicts, unintentional mistakes, miscommunications, you name it. Things that no longer matter anymore to either of us, things that should not have mattered in the first place. In those arguments, I became the worst version of myself. I was the most impatient and confrontational jerk, I wanted to rant, I simply just wanted her to know how stressed I was, but I did not listen, I did not let her feel heard, and I was emotionally not there to support her. None of those arguments ended in a good way. We were both tired and frustrated at the end of the arguments, we went to bed with resentment and nothing was solved.

(The first argument was about her friend. Paige has a best friend Hayden, but unfortunately she is misandristic. Hayden hates Paige's ex-boyfriend, Hayden hates her ex-husband, Hayden hates me. During our early relationship, after I learned how much Paige treasures their friendship, I put in great efforts into building a friendship with Hayden. However it quickly broke apart after Hayden texted Paige that she was freaked out by me forgetting to close her front door for 5 seconds to fetch something from my car, she suffered a panic attack from thinking that her dog would run outside, and Paige told me "Hayden is my family, and family is more important than anything else, more important than you." 9 months into our relationship, in July 2026, Paige and I had a trip to Michigan to visit her family. On our way back, she stopped by a dispensary to purchase marijuana products, all the way till that moment did I finally realize what Paige has been frequently spending time on hanging out at Hayden's place. I told Paige I would hope she can give up cannabis and it should never be part of our future life together. "This is my body, I choose what's best for my body."

The second argument was a disagreement on expenses. Paige owns the house and pays the mortgage, she also has a back house behind it as rental property. When I first moved in with her, she mentioned that her ex-boyfriend still owes her a great sum of money in rent and she wants to sue, and I did not understand at first. A few months

after my move-in, Paige brought it up that she wishes I can pay her a monthly $700 as half of the $1400 mortgage, and I had already accumulated a few thousands since February. She also recently recruited a renter for her back house for $1,000 a month. I told her I would not wish to since I was already paying hundreds in groceries and restaurants each month and was running out of all sorts of financial resources. Also I mentioned that it would damage our relationship if she intends to make money from me by having me and the renter paying more than her mortgage. “Equal responsibility means equal ownership.” I said this exact sentence to her, and that was like a match thrown into a hay stack. We argued for hours.

I apologized to her 2 days later, however a third argument on a similar topic broke out a week later, in early September. This time, she erased me from her life.

I wrote this parenthetical section between October 15th and 16th after I was discharged from the hospital and spent the night at Nicklas’s place, since then I have been receiving a lot of encouragement from Nicklas, as well as I have been reaching out to friends to hang out, to make sure I force myself to go outside as least once per day. Although nobody besides Nicklas knows anything about my hospitalization and I still intend to tell few about what happened to me this 2026, I have been sharing my struggles with all the difficulties I am facing in life with others and I have been receiving nothing but empathy and positive encouragement. Unfortunately I am the only person in my family to be in the US and I haven’t really shared much of my personal life with my family members, including my parents, as well as I intend to not share all these with most of the friends or acquaintances I have made in the past years. Due to change of jobs and constant moving to new cities and apartments, I have lost connections with majority of them and once I feel the distance is too far to share life on a regular basis, I don’t know how to open up again and I dwell back into my “bottle everything up” mindset, and having several close friends to talk to in Charlotte is already the best situation I have been in since Covid. I feel lonely deeply inside.

For the past 5 days, I have explored a lot of options: For my stay in the US, I have reached out to almost every lawyer I can find contact information about, I have also made my decision that if it requires me to make a great sacrifice to resume a normal life and career, I will do it. Regardless of how many years it is going to cost me or how much financial burden I will have to carry. For my backup plan, I also am exploring the Canadian job market, and reaching out to recruiters in China. These are also overly competitive options so they are essentially not safe nets. I force myself to leave the house to play some tennis or just simply go to a pawn shop to sell my personal belongings or even just eat at a restaurant. I have taken a lot of actions on doing things and this gives me a great feeling, but still I have to admit that I am in a greatly

depressed situation, especially when night comes. Paige is staying at Hayden's place and I have no one to talk to in this house. I have no clear future in this country and I have no idea where I am going to stay by the end of this month when Paige wants to evict me and erase me completely from her life. I know the latter has already happened, which makes me even sadder. I barely eat anything everyday and It would be lucky if I can get 4 hours of sleep any night. The anxiety reduce prescription I received from the ER doctor doesn't help me much, it only slows my brain down to stop me from thinking too much, however my vision is blurry, and my body is tired, I have lost my sense of time and my feeling of attachment to things in life, I am sitting on the dining room chair not knowing what day or time it is and what things are important and what are not anymore.

The depression is coming back, stronger than ever, and I haven't drunk or eaten anything for the whole day. I have been keeping the doors and curtains open to get some sunlight but I can't remind myself to get food or water. My body weight has been dropping everyday and for a brief moment my mind wandered into thinking about a future where I have no job anywhere, I have no one to care about me, I cannot stay in this country that I have spent 7 years building my life in, and Paige has forever left my life. One moment later, I realized I just googled painless suicide again. Do I want to buy a gun and end my life? Should I hang myself somewhere quiet? Would a quick knife stab to the heart do it? I do not know.)

In mid September, she decided to break up with me after our final argument, and then came my realization, came my apologies and my efforts. But it was too late, I was never given a chance for redemption. October 14th happened, and my world collapsed.

It took me weeks of thinking and reflecting to understand my own mistakes, to answer just one simple question: Why would I do that if I did not mean to and why would I think like this if I wanted to hurt no one. I wanted to believe you, the person reading this letter, had a genuine friendship with me, and I sincerely put in my best effort to be a good friend to you. But as I was thinking through each of your names, I realized for years of our friendship, I took many things for granted and I owe many of you an apology. You showed me care, you showed me love, you trusted me unconditionally. And I was never as good a friend as I thought myself to be. I said things that hurt your feelings, I did things that unintentionally caused damage to our friendship, and yet you showed me patience. I am sorry. I wish I was given another chance so I could make things right for you again.

I was a heavily flawed man, I still am.

One thing I had always been struggling with is seeing my failure without comparison. I wanted to blame my childhood and how competitiveness was printed into my brain by the toxic environment I grew up in, but at the end of my life, I saw my own lack of desire and determination and I blamed none anymore. I had been searching for a job for a whole year and I had been connected to so many people on professional platforms. It was still hard for me to not think about the things I could have achieved reading about an acquaintance of mine getting promoted or starting a new job at a desirable company. I would always think I could have done that if some external factor didn't happen to me, like if I had already gone through the process and acquired my greed card, I could have achieved much more in life without these restrictions. I should still have a place to live in and build a life together with Paige, I should still earn a decent wage and could afford to pay her rent, do couple counselings, and take risks in life. I could tell my family and friend groups that I would settle down soon and put all my past 7 years of anxiety away, my anxiety over the fear of Covid and food insecurity in graduate school, over the loss of my grandfather in 2021, over having to postpone graduation due to nationwide visa processing delay and potentially losing my Amazon job offer, over having to move across the whole country and restart my life in a new city where I know nobody, over the Amazon layoff in 2022, over traveling across the country again yet not being accepted at my new job because of a mistake I made, over waves after waves of layoffs that eventually pushed me to join Microsoft and disruptely put an end to my Credit Karma job that already went half way through immigration process, and eventually the loss of my job at Microsoft that ended my work visa, my income, and my whole life in the US.

I wish I had a green card. I wish I was not shackled by this system. I wish I could give Paige all I had.

I was not always like the person you know today. For most of my life prior to coming to the US, I always had imposter syndrome and I always felt that I had to put in more effort than everyone else to deserve anything, any achievement or love in life. America changed my mindset, I became a person with more confidence, I started to understand how my belief in myself affects people's perspective on me, why I should not think of myself as the last person to deserve enjoyment in life. However that made me ignorant, that made me arrogant. When I first started my career, I was humble and always talked the least in meetings and shared credits of my work with others. When I started to realize how others would dogfight and backstab for their own visibility and promotion, how people always gave themselves the highest praise on performance reviews, my mindset changed. Over the last 5 years, I became overconfident in myself and I always thought I was unique and had high values. I was telling myself I received a good education, I was able to solve complex problems and I was desirable. In fact I am not. I am a visa slave that corporations deem disposible, I never have a community to care for me and support me, I do not have any family here. A gust of wind can blow me away like an autumn leaf. I am scared to settle down and only spend every penny on essentials. I have nothing but just a number on my broker account, I am also not hard working enough to be viewed as an indispensable part of any company, I am not smart enough to be a part of any community that drives positive impact, I am not even good enough to be seen as a forever partner. Everything I ever created or owned, is of little intrinsic value to others, is some cheap, mass produced, disposable thing. There is a winter wool jacket that my mother put in my suitcase 7 years ago when I left for the airport. For all these years I have treasured it as my most valuable item that I rarely wear to preserve it. How much does it cost today? Probably a hundred at any department store, even lower at discount stores. For years, I always thought I am successful because I am building financial independence for the future, but it was all just an illusion created by a single number on my broker account. I was fooled by myself and some blinking digits on a screen into thinking I was great.

I did not commit suicide because of my breakup with Paige, it was rather the last straw I could bear. I had to admit this whole year of unemployment followed by the feeling of unimportance changed many aspects of my life. I was raised to have a goal, but not a purpose. Every stage of my life, I was chasing a goal, either it's an education opportunity, or a career advancement, but I had no purpose for myself. Never in my life had I had a purpose, I never really spent time building a dream or chasing it. I had always been comparing myself to peers to find a goal that I thought I would be going after. Before age 28, It was always my education, before 2026, it was always my job. This was the first time ever in my life that I felt I really wanted to create a life together with someone, that I really wanted to build a purpose for the rest of my life. With unemployment came all the visa uncertainties and changes in my mood. I could see my

behavior changed, I was no longer the caring partner early in our relationship, I got impatient often and could not think rationally when problems occurred. I wanted to be heard but often I only ranted, and Paige was there to hear them all. I said things that forever hurt Paige's feelings and undermined our relationship, and I would not be given another chance ever again.

Within this indescribable regret, I did feel a slight sense of grievance, life had always treated me harshly, and punished me even more. I was thrown into a swim or drown situation for almost every new life event and rarely was there anybody to guide me, to hold my hands and tell me "you will be ok." If I were given some simple guidance, or just some positive feedback, things would be much different. I went to local tennis parks and often saw young kids learn how to play it with their coach or parents, I sat there watching the parents holding their hands when they swing, watching the coach hand toss a ball after another one after another one to help them correct their forms, I listened to them getting constructive feedback and encouragement when mistakes were made, and I got emotional, a grown man in his 30s, having a sense of resentment of being ignored and criticized for decades, and a sense of envy towards kids for having a normal childhood.

I did not take mental health seriously when I was a kid, more accurately I was not really aware of it. Over the years I observed all my behaviors and my words, and how they impacted both others and myself, and decided to take actions about it. It had already been a struggle to learn about my own limitations, and address them. Impulsive thought was one of them. Often when I got deeply engaged in a conversation with you, I knew what would be the best thing to say in different scenarios to help build our relationship, but some thoughts always came first and I just said them. I always felt being honest and genuine would do no harm, but I was wrong, I always felt that I wanted to suggest things that made me feel "constructive", and often they just sounded like criticism and negativity. I hurt you, and I hope you could accept my apology.

When I turned 30, I was introduced to tennis for the first time, and it quickly became everything in my life. Many of you connected with me through tennis, and had a long lasting relationship built on top of this common hobby. You may enjoy playing with me every once in a while as a nice weekend leisure. But for me, it is way more than just a hobby or a sport, it is way more than just a way that I build friendship upon. It is everything to me, and I mean it. Tennis comes before my day to day job, it comes before any possessions I have or ever had, and it even comes before any single relationship. Tennis did not support my mental health, it was my mental health. It helped me go through many hard times, it taught me how to focus, how to sacrifice, and how to let it go. Without tennis, I would not even make it so far into 2026. Tennis injured me

many times. It taught me to endure pain, it taught me to push through. Tennis forced me to think for my own health, it forced me to get up early, to eat healthy, to work hard. If there is one thing you remember me for, please let it be tennis.

I made bad decisions in life, one particular in tennis, I was very ashamed to share with anyone but I wanted to share with you today. With all the injuries I had, one of them I carried everyday for over a year and half till this very moment I am writing down this letter. In April 2025, I participated in a serve game while visiting a WTA tournament. The venue court was too small and I was trying too hard, because I cared too much about total strangers' view of me and I just had this stupid urge to prove myself. I jumped high and served hard, body twisted, when I landed on the side of my ankle, my whole body slammed onto the ground hard, and both of my feet were in tremendous pain. I climbed up and insisted on finishing the serve. When blood dried on my legs, I struggled to walk back to my seat to finish watching the rest of the tournament, insisting that it was just a bad joint twist. Todd helped me walk back into the car and Kevin drove me back later that night. "You should go see a doctor." Kevin insisted. "Nah I will be fine, not my first time twisting my ankle, plus my deductible is high." I called the ER that night and how stupid I was that the first question I asked was "How much is an emergency X ray?" I had been so cheap on myself and always thought money was often more important than my problems, even my own health. I didn't go to the ER that night and it took me two weeks to be able to walk again. When the inflammation disappeared, my feet could no longer move without a constant blunt pain on the joint, and it bothered me everyday. Before I could fix this issue, I lost my job and my health insurance, and I was never given a chance to fix it. Physical pain put such a big toll on my mental health, and my positive personality.

I have sat in the backseat of a police car 3 times in my life, all in the last 7 years. You already read about my last time, and the first time was surprisingly similar. During Covid I lost my grandfather, and I was facing delay on my pending work authorization application. Being forced to extend my graduation date and fear of losing my new grad job offer, I felt my world was ending and I totally lost hope. The university police escorted me to the hospital, and for the first time in my life, I saw what a psych ward looked like and I would never expect that years later, I would once again be in one. I was never an ACAB person before I came to the US, until the second time. That event put me into great depression and totally changed my view and the trajectory of my life. I view politics from a completely different angle, I see the power imbalance in average people's struggles, and I advocate so hard for the injustice. But before all these transformations happened in me, I endured 2 years of struggle. Eventually I decided to let go of this burden and shared it on LinkedIn in 2024.

I want to love and be loved. It is such a simple thing for so many people yet it is just incredibly hard for me. I love you and many others, and I truly do. But so much effort needs to be put into expressing it and still often I can not find the most natural way to do it. It becomes an awkward hug, or a series of questions about your life update that sound more like interrogation, or a joke that feels very forced. But I want you to know that as bad as my words sound in all these social interactions, I have only had one intention, and that was to understand you, and to love you more. I hate that I also receive and interpret love with much difference. I acknowledge all the heartfelt words you share with me, I see your heart, but often my response falls behind my thoughts. I see and appreciate all the efforts you put into nursing this friendship and I wish I knew better ways to give back. Growing up, one thing my parents rarely did was to say “I love you.” They rarely gave me physical touch. They loved me in different ways, a bowl of fruits popped up on my desk after a study break, a thicker blanket replaced the thin one on the bed after temperature dropped. I still believe it would make me happier if they were more direct and more vocal, but I never doubted their love. I learned all these from my parents, and unfortunately I became a copy of my parents. Do I regret not telling you more that I love you? Yes, yes I do.

I had thought about this a lot for the past several weeks and to be fair, I had a plan, but it was not the life I wanted. I do not want to abandon my life here. I do not see myself happy in any possible life path that you are not part of. I do not see myself successful if I lose all these friendships and enrichments in life. I do not want to lose you. It breaks my heart, and I am already beyond broken.

I want to say something to each one of you. Some of you have known me for years and we shared great memories. It is impossible to gather every thought I ever had about you and write them down. It is just what I have been thinking for the past weeks.

To Dad Wang Wenqiu and Mom Gao Jinhua:

I am sorry this letter reached you in this way. For two decades, you raised me and taught me with everything you had, in every way you could. I could no longer accompany you for the rest of your life, as your own child, I felt regrettably ashamed. Please forgive me one last time.

I have been living aboard for 7 years and I miss my home very much. I miss you, I miss grandma, I miss my cousins, I miss my aunts and uncles, and I really, really miss grandpa.

I am proud to share with you. In all these 7 years, I overcame many difficulties and grew into a completely different person. I finished my education as I promised, and I enjoyed a career working for 3 different companies, although it was filled with never ending stress, anxiety and uncertainties. I lived in Boston, Seattle, and Charlotte. I travelled to many new places, I grew new hobbies, I made many new friends, I had some relationships, and I had done everything while being completely financially independent since career day 1. I became braver, more direct, more outgoing, more motivated. I surrounded myself with friends of all races from all countries. I could get things done.

I am still as frugal as I ever was. I live below my means, and I save for retirement. The most valuable thing I ever own is my car, and I bought it with my first paycheck. I paid off the loan on time exactly 48 months later.

I am sorry I did not treat my physical health and mental health as the highest priority, and got myself into this mess. I have injured myself, I have gotten into trouble, I have gone through many tough moments. I rarely asked professionals for help, it was a bad life decision, and I apologize.

I find myself to act and think differently than a lot of my peers in many situations, and I often struggle more than necessary. Either it’s getting good grades at school, navigating office politics at jobs, or growing and maintaining friendships outside of work. It always felt that I was putting in more efforts than others and seeing less results. I could not understand this disconnection and I always felt my efforts were in the wrong direction or even in the opposite direction in many cases. The harder I try, the further away I push people. I was never diagnosed by any psychiatrist, but I just have to be honest and admit that I strongly feel that I have autistism, this caused me so many troubles in life. I was bullied in schools, I could not navigate through complicated situations, I had hard times sharing my emotions. So much of my life has not been in my control, and I still do

not know how to react. I am crying so hard writing this part down because I just want to be normal.

It took me countless days and nights to reflect on my own childhood and youth life to search for an answer, and I feel it has a lot to do with the teachings I received, and how I perceived them. At school I was always taught to be quiet, to sit still, to not cause inconvenience, to hide my emotions, to follow the correct answers without thinking out of the box, while in the meantime I was also taught to compete, to compare, to base my value, as a person, as a human being, on my performance. No teachers ever taught me how to share, how to love, how to be vulnerable.

Unfortunately you did not teach me much on those either, and I lagged behind emotionally for decades. When I was a kid, both of you were always so busy at work, and we were always moving from one place to another. I had so few childhood friends that I felt a deep connection with. In my teenage years, dad, you were always somewhere in a different country, trying to make more for the family so we could afford bigger houses and better things, but you were not with me. You were never there to play sports with me, you never taught me how to shave, how to dress, how to help mom fix issues in the house. You missed all my graduation, my music or sport events, and my birthdays. All you ever said was listen to mom and be a good student and prepare for college. And mom, you dedicated so much into your career, but you never shared a single moment of it with me, you hid all the family financials from me, and you never let me make decisions. I had to learn everything myself, and mistakes were unavoidable, but I was punished so harshly every time. I was never given a chance to grow into a bigger comfort zone because of that.

I know it is more of a cultural norm and social expectation than your direct decision, but do you still remember Wei Ran? My first love, my very first girlfriend, our relationship was under such scrutiny from you and her parents because we were expected to treat study as a full time job with absolute zero distraction. We had to hide from everyone to find places to date, we had to give notes to classmates to pass to each other because you were monitoring our phones. It was such a pure and innocent love and you twisted it so hard, it deformed forever. It is part of me that can never be healed.

Covid was a really hard thing for me, I was given one chance to experience American college life and it totally ruined it. I spent most of my time in my own room. Before that I was making friends in different colleges around Boston, I was traveling around New England, and I was applying for jobs to support myself. They were all gone. I went through food insecurities so I visited food banks that summer, but I took nothing for granted as I volunteered there the whole summer as well. I gave my labor and was

honest to myself. Life in Seattle was not that much better mostly because I was still struggling building connections with people and Seattle is a lonely place. Adopting Chica was the best thing ever in those 2 years.

In 2022, I made the hardest decision in my life to disconnect from you, because 3 things happened. It's been 4 years since we talked and it is unimaginably hard for me. I was so happy to share my life update with dad that I was dating Dessa, she is a wonderful girl, but just not Asian. I sent photos of her to you, and you simply replied "Too old". Please, she was 26! Why did not you just give me something positive, why did not you just give me some good wishes. Two words! You twisted it again. Mom spent so much time preparing for the video call and was trying her very best to talk to Dessa in English and giving us best wishes, you could have done that as well. I was very depressed at my work at that time, and Chica was the joy of my life. She helped me go through so many hard moments and she was always by my side when I needed her, and mom and dad why would you say "Dogs are dirty, get rid of it"? At the end of 2022, layoff was scheduled to happen at my team and I spent months looking for a new job and it was my only ticket to escape Amazon and escape the depressing Seattle. I wanted to put my mental health first and start it over again in a new place, but both of you just had to try so hard to convince me to stay, simply because you never heard about the company name and value career "prestige" over everything else. I knew you only ever had good intentions for me, you always wanted me to be successful in life, but you cared too much about superficial things, you had been dwelling in your fixed mindset for so long, you never truly appreciated my happiness. When I finally escaped Amazon, I made my decision.

I moved to this city called Charlotte on the east coast in 2023, and I was greeted by many great coworkers at Credit Karma. They introduced tennis to me, and that became the very foundation of my everyday happiness. Everyone mentioned in this letter has played tennis with me and I could not live without it. That period of my life was truly wonderful. Microsoft never treated me well, and Paige came into my life later. One year later, my life is gone.

I want you to know that in my whole life, I have never smoked a cigarette, never used marijuana, never taken any drug, never gambled, never hired any escort, never went to a single night club, never had a single commitment-less relationship. I tried to make you proud, and I am still the same good boy you raised till the last day of my life.

To Chica:

At nights, I still dream about the day I adopted you. You just gave birth to a litter, finished weaning, and were spayed. I was so eager to go to Everett animal shelter to see you. You were so wonderful and perfect, every inch of you.

The workers there only ever told me that you were a 2 year old stray dog, nothing more. I drove you back home, you were shaking the whole way. I made two posts of you on my social media. The first one was a picture of me holding you in the shelter with your eyes filled with tears, I wrote “From today, you will never be abandoned again.” The second was a selfie with you sleeping in my arms, and I wrote “Nobody knows when was the last time Chica slept in a warm and safe environment, but when she devoured every food given to her and immediately started cuddling in a stronger’s arms that just met her 3 hours ago and fell asleep, my heart melted.” You tried to jump onto my bed the first night but I was not mentally ready, when you did it the second night, I took you in my bed and never let you sleep alone ever.

You were the delight of my life in Seattle. You were the only reason I survived.

You are so curious and so energetic, and so eager to explore every new place we stay. You always drag me for miles to go home when it gets dark outside after a long walk, and you always remember the route. You are the smartest dog I have ever seen.

You are my first dog, and my last dog. When you were tested positive for heartworm in 2023, my heart shattered into a thousand pieces. When I was driving you home from the hospital on the highway, I saw life moments flashing in front of my eyes, and I had to stop the car because tears could not stop pouring. I locked you inside the house for 12 weeks to control and cure the infection, and you never got sad with me for putting you in a crate for hours everyday.

I thanked God so much for blessing the day you were cured, and I have never been religious in my life.

You are very selective on whom you like, but you are so kind to Bella and Paige and you adopt so many lifestyle changes to live with them. Bella is old and has chronic issues, and you groom her everyday for hours, you share your treat with her and you are always lying by her side to cheer her up.

I am so sorry I am giving up on my own life and I can no longer take care of you. But I promise you one of my trusted friends will accept you and share our friendship stories with you and take care of you for the rest of your life.

I treated you like a life partner and you indeed are the only partner that walked with me to the end.

To Paige Meinke:

I wrote many pages for this, so many thoughts went through my mind. I really believed she loved me, I really believed she cared. She pressed charges on me and evicted me, just to force me out of her life 5 days earlier than her plan. She told me that she did not care if I could not keep myself safe in a shelter, that she did not care if Chica would be put down in the shelter, that she thought I could not put my ego down to see the reality. She watched my world burn, she saw the flame fading for a brief moment, and she lit it up with her own fire this time.

She was heartless.

I deleted them all.

To Nicklas Jensen:

You supported me so much in the past weeks and I can not express how much appreciation I have for you. You are so rational as a person and so thoughtful as a partner and friend.

I said to you the other day that you are my closest family in the US, and I mean it.

Words can not describe how much love I have for you and how much I wish you to enjoy a wonderful life with your wife and your upcoming new born.

I am immensely grateful for the day we met. I am grateful for witnessing your love with your girlfriend and then marriage. I am grateful that a great person like you can find happiness.

Please forgive me, I lied to you that I was ok. And please forever remember me.

To Kevin Melkonyan:

I am still confused why you are always so positive in your life, to a depressed person like me, you are like a walking rainbow. But I know life is never easy on you as well, you just handle it way too well. And I always appreciate the teachings I received from you.

You always tell me to be myself, to play tennis in my own style, to take control of the pace when facing tough opponents. You also keep telling me I am stubborn despite that I have been trying so hard to adjust and follow your guidance. I never understood that part before, now I know. Yes I am stubborn, and thank you for being honest with me.

I do not have the courage you have facing uncertainties in life, and I do not have the determination you have.

To Nathan Klinge, Casey Mink, Todd Hardy, Vladimir Gerasik, Carlos Barreda, Khang Pham, and many others:

Thank you all for shining so much light into my life, and please accept my apology that I never really opened up to you because I did not want to bother you or give you any stress. All the time we spent together, I was always trying to share positivity and be funny.

Nathan, you are my favorite roommate, ever. I see how much care you have for your girlfriend and how clear your life goal is, and I wish you all the best pursuing them.

Casey, you told me that in christianity, life is all about forgiveness and love. You told me how you want to enjoy having a consistent moral standard and enjoy life as an honorable musician. I respect you deeply.

Todd, you know how much I enjoy playing tennis with you because you are a player that never gives up any easy points, you are also a great person in life that never gives up as well. Please keep fighting on my behalf, and please be my advocate for a brighter future for everyone.

Vlad, you were the first friend I made in tennis, and you supported me so much over the years. You are a good person with such a high moral standard and rules of life despite having to suffer with your family so much from war. Please send my regards to your mom and your son and let your mom know, Chica loves her.

Carlos, your life is full of stories, and you are a person of so many skills, and you have such a good heart. I am sorry the physical distance did not allow us to be closer but I truly enjoyed the limited time we shared together, and I will forever remember your kindness.

Khang, I just realized you are the only Asian on this list. A little funny thing in such a heavy letter. You are an incredibly strong person with an incredibly soft heart. You always share with me how much you care for people and you are always there when needed. I am sorry you just came back to tennis and have to read through this letter. I wish you all the best in life with your new born, and please never stop playing tennis for me.

To my cousins Wu Yong and Wang Yingying:

I left home 7 years ago, and I stopped talking to mom and dad 4 years ago. You always check on me, always offer help and ask me about all my life updates. You are so encouraging whenever I need you, whether it is highlights in life I want to share or lowlights that I have nobody to talk to. You take care of me my whole life without asking anything in return. I love you, and please continue to have a great life with our family in China, for me.

To my childhood friends Niu Zihao, Wang Shaohua, and my best friend at Tufts Lei Dameng:

I lied, I am sorry my life is not what it looks like on social media, it is not what it looks like on the photos I shared with you. I lost my job, I never got my green card, and I never married Paige. It ended in this way. We have known each other for so many years, and when I look at all the photos we took together when we were young, I cry. Wherever you are and wherever you want to be in your life, do it, and please do it for me.

And lastly, to the probate attorney:

Dear Sir or Madam,

Thank you for helping my parents navigate through this hardship. My will is as follows:

1. Please transfer the title of my Honda Accord (WA plate BYV6034) to Ms. Meinke as a gift. The car has been fully paid off.
2. Please close all my bank accounts, and pay off all my credit accounts. If the remaining balance is not enough, please liquidate part of my investments.
3. Please pay off my October 14th medical bill by liquidating part of my investments
4. Please help me collect the judgement I won against my former landlord in Massachusetts (Somerville District Court 2510SC001253 Wang, Jiawei v. Li, Tianquan)
5. Please transfer ownership of my investment accounts and retirement accounts to assigned beneficiaries.
6. Please give my dog, Chica, to Ms. Meinke, if Meinke is unable or unwilling to take care of her, please give her to any of the other people (excluding my parents) mentioned in this letter. If none can do so, please surrender her to a local no-kill animal shelter for adoption.
7. And finally, please properly hand over all electronic devices containing personal photos, documents and all other private data to my parents, and hand over all other devices and hardware to Ms. Meinke.

Part 2: this part was written after my hospitalization on October 14, and before my arrest on October 25th.

Hi.

I shared this letter with you because I trust you with my heart and appreciate your positive impact in my life, and I would like to share my story with you.

This is a very long letter containing details of lots of my previous life altering events and my emotions that I have bottled up for years or even decades. So I respectfully ask you not to share it with anyone else.

For years, I have been trying to hide many aspects of my life. I keep things only to myself as a secret or give people white lies. It is a combination of everything:

I grew up not receiving much guidance and life teaching from my father, so I tend to be self sufficient even when things are going out of control and asking for external help can help me improve the situation.
I grew up in an overly competitive environment where my value as a kid, a teenager, a student, was largely based on my performance compared to my peers, so I tend to only share positive news and hide the rest due to fear of criticism.
I was depressed for the most part of my 20s, because at that age I made important life decisions too easily and I made wrong decisions. I wasted 5 years of my college years studying medicine at a medical university that I learned nothing from, then another 3 years of my life doing research in Japan, trying to find meanings in new life and only to find out it was not what I wanted. I was greatly depressed after coming back to China, but eventually I looked for medical help and went into a solitary state for 18 months, and finally made my decision to restart my life and come to the US in 2019 to earn a master's degree in hope to find a new career as a programmer and a new life here.

Many mistakes have been made in the past 7 years, and with all my efforts to assimilate myself into American culture and American society, I still struggle to maintain a balance between my own culture and American culture, while also struggle to keep a deep interpersonal connection with many of my friends, as they gradually fade away in my life due to distance, or job change, or life change and commitments.

You are one of the last few that I give my whole heart to without hesitation, because I know you would accept me as who I truly am without judgement, and you are a wonderful person that at certain point in my life, saved me from falling into the abyss I did not dare to stare at. Despite that I never told you you did.

This letter was initially written in Chinese to my parents in early October as a suicide letter, as I was in tremendous fear of losing everything in my life and I wanted to

document the last moments of it, share them with my parents, so they could one day forgive me for giving up on my own life. However I realized it would be an even greater burden for them to carry for the rest of their lives, as in fact, I have not been back to China since I came to the US in 2019 and I have not talked to them since 2022. My parents are entering their 60s, with almost half of their lives dedicated to raising me as their only child, I could not imagine the amount of shock and sadness my suicide would bring to them. All the life savings, dedications, commitments, just to see the only child vanish 8,000 miles away in a foreign country on the other side of earth, not knowing why, and most likely will never know and have to carry this burden till the end of their own lives. I would be the most selfish person that ever lived.

It took me great effort to cross out suicide from my plan, when you read this letter, I am still alive, and I still love you.

In early September 2026, I had just finished my trip to Boston for a legal matter. I had been unemployed for the whole 2026, and was facing visa issues. So I was exhausted, both physically, mentally, and financially. In a span of 2 weeks, I got into 3 arguments with Paige Meinke, my then girlfriend, over trivial topics we did not agree on. I said things that went too far and hurt both of our feelings, and I let my emotions all out. Paige decided to break up with me 2 days after the last argument and asked me to leave. I finally came to the realization how much I loved her, how much I committed to this relationship, how much I wanted all these to eventually work out, and how much I hoped to continue to have a life in the US. I also came to the realization that till that moment, I had been ignoring lots of signals she gave me in the previous months. In June I was able to get an offer for a decent job with visa sponsorship however the company rescinded it after the immigration lawyer told them the risks they would expose themselves to with all the ongoing scrutiny on work visas from the Trump administration, and over the course of June, July and August, I became an emotionless monster that only cared about applications, interviews, and visas. I acted as a self-centered person, I constantly complained about how awful my situation was and how much mental stress I was going through, and I was constantly asking everyone around me to understand me and extend their resources to me. I did not realize Paige was going through just as much stress as me, Paige also wanted the relationship to work out, Paige was begging me for care, for attention, and for love. And those 3 arguments broke her.

Over the next 4 weeks, I tried everything I could to fix my situation, to ask her for forgiveness and a second chance. It was the hardest thing I have ever done in my whole 33 years of life, the second one was not even close. I sat down with her for tens of hours, if not hundreds, to apologize for every mistake I made through this whole year of relationship. I completely opened my heart and shared every vulnerability of mine.

Everyday I was crying, I told her how much I felt sorry for having those arguments, how much I regretted letting her down, how much I wished I could have made the right decisions from the beginning, and how much I begged her to allow me to fix things and to make them right for the future, because I really hoped there was still a future for her and me.

Everyday Paige was a different person, one day she would be nice and willing to have conversations or spend time with me doing things together, another day she would completely block me out of her life with no words, no smiles, nor any acknowledgment of my existence. She would be gone for hours or even a whole day giving no updates, with me worrying about her at home. She would block me out of her social circle and make me feel extremely isolated and lonely.

I told her I was suffering, I told her I had great fears, and I truly exhausted every single way I could to make things right. I apologized in every way, I shared with her all my learnings throughout the process and my realizations about what I could have done and I could still do for her. I took actions to show her care and love and to make up for all mistakes, I made detailed future plans. I knew she had been bothered by her old car for a while at that point while focusing on renovation projects of her back house and navigating the job market, so I even proposed gifting her a new SUV she always wanted, so her burden could be eased.

But it was too late. “The feelings are gone”, “The well dried up”, “I want someone better”. The words stabbed into my hearts, I felt so much pain, every, single, night.

99 times I knocked on the door, 99 times the door was shut in my face.

On October 13th, I searched for my finest suit and put it on for the first time in 4 years. I took Paige to a fine dining restaurant in uptown Charlotte, and I spelled “Jiawei”, “likes”, “Paige” on the bananagrams while sitting outside of the theater waiting for our movie to start. There was no handholding, no kiss, not a single “I love you”, but I made her smile, and I thought for a brief moment maybe things would start to turn bright.

No, they did not. My life crumbled down on October 14th.

That night, after a whole day outside hanging out with her friends, she came back, also two of her friends, Hayden was one of them. It was an awkward moment for me as Paige had already made the breakup known to many. Both of her friends would know that she no longer wanted to have a relationship with me and expressed intention to drive me out of the house. I came to the dining room to welcome them, but was greeted

with no acknowledgement. An awkward dinner was followed by an even more awkward card game, as 3 of them started to share their life updates and invite each other to upcoming social events and I kept silent. One of her friends read some tarot cards for Paige and me, lots of the readings were about how a new life is awaiting Paige and she will be happier than now, and how I should embrace the challenge of the upcoming life events and find new opportunities in a new place.

Like many nights in the previous weeks, after they were gone, I called Paige to stay for a moment and asked her if she wanted to talk. I can not remember what I said anymore, as the words felt like they were bleeding from my heart. I told her I truly and completely exhausted everything I could say, and I could do, to save this relationship, and I was in great fear for the upcoming loss of everything that I had ever built and owned in my whole career, and my whole life in this country. “That is exactly why I would never want to be with you, because you just don’t listen.”

I could not breathe, for a few seconds the sky collapsed and smashed me to the ground. I had never in my life experienced such an acute pain in my body. I had broken my bones over the years, I was told I might have leukemia when I was 18, I ran out of the house in the middle of the night to ask neighbor for help when my parents turned arguments into fights when I was a teenager, I saw my grandfather pass away but Covid didn’t even let me go back and see him for the last time. None of them was even close to the pain I had at that moment. I fell onto the ground, I was banging my arms against my chest, I was squeezing my fists to the point they started bleeding. Darkness, my eyes went blind and I saw pure darkness, it scared me. Paige pulled out her phone and started secretly filming me, I lost my voice and the tears tasted like razors in my mouth, “My life is ending! There is nothing for me anymore! I have two weeks to live!”

“You need help.” Paige went outside the house to make phone calls, I was scared, I did not know what to do, I grabbed her car key and took her firearm from the glovebox and hid it inside my car’s trunk. To this day I still have no explanation why I did that, but at that very moment, I did not want to kill myself, and I did not want to hurt anyone else. I saw red and blue lights, a police car pulled in front of the house, and I left the house from the backdoor.

I kept walking, I did not know where I wanted to go, I just wanted to avoid everyone. “They are after me, I am doomed.” I thought to myself as I walked off the main street into the dark neighborhood, I kept my head down and was too scared to look at my phone. 10 minutes later, a police car passed me. “I need to hide.” I found some trees behind a school and sat between them. 1 minute passed, 2 minutes passed, I kept my

breath, I crawled on the grass. The car came back, door shut, voices from the radio, a flash light waved through the bushes, and it stopped on me. “Don’t shoot, I have no weapon on me.” I raised my hands over my head. The officer pinned me on the ground, arms on the back, handcuff on, then he held me up. Two more cars came, I tried to explain to them I did not commit any crime. “You are not in trouble, we are taking you to the hospital.”

Back seat in a police car, again.

The female officer asked me if I needed the window down for air, I said no thank you. She already knew what happened, she already heard Paige’s side of the story and was thinking yet another young man losing his mind because of a girl’s rejection. No, it was more than that, way more, my life was broken. But I did not argue. She started asking me about my education, about my life in Rock Hill, about my family. I told her the truth. She was a good cop, and she listened and cared.

The ER checked me in, they took away all my belongings and gave me a scrub. I sat in the chair like a flat balloon. The nurses took my vitals and sent me into my cell. I looked at the clock on the wall, 12 pm.

I sat in the bed looking at the ceiling, 1 hour passed, 2 hours passed. The social worker came. I told her all my story, a whole year of unemployment, relationship, uncertainties, visa issues, mental stress, financial hardship, arguments, breakup, thoughts of suicide. Then the doctor came, similar questions, similar answers. Then the nurse came. “Mr Wang, the police want to know where you hid Paige’s gun.” “It’s in my trunk, the key is in my pants’ pocket. There is a backup key in the house.” I was too tired and just wanted to keep the conversation short. The backup key did not work, they issued a warrant and brute forced into my car. I could not care less.

The night passed, I did not get much sleep, I was staring at the ceiling till my vision got blurry, till I could not keep my eyes open and fell asleep, I woke up 5 minutes later, I stared at the ceiling again, repeat.

Another nurse came, I lost sense of time already, along with her a stack of forms. She was here to assess me, she was the judge that could either send me into confinement hell or release me. But she did not judge, she asked a lot of questions, I answered honestly. She showed so much sympathy and even started giving me mental consulting. I cried, for several months, she was the first person that felt for me. Nobody else knew, nobody else cared.

Morning came, new day shift nurses came, they brought me breakfast. I tried to eat, it was hard. My throat hurt like hell, my hands shaking. I struggled to finish it, and sat in my bed listening to the nurses chat. There was no window in the ER, I had no sense of the outside world. I just sat there, waiting for time to pass.

“Your friend Nicklas Jensen is on the phone and wants to talk to you.” The nurse knocked on my door. I was surprised, I did not expect anyone to know my whereabouts. Paige contacted Nicklas’s wife and told her I could use his help, that’s why Nicklas called, without hesitation. “I heard what happened and I want to help.” I cried.

Two more hours passed, and they finally discharged me. I went through the ER door, Nicklas was there, in the waiting room. He came forward and hugged me, I needed that. He mentioned Paige did not want to see me again and wanted me to leave the house, and suggested I stay with him for the night. He drove me back to our place so I could clean myself and collect my clothes. “Jiawei, you need to leave now! What you did to Paige was disgusting!" I heard banging on the bathroom door while cleaning myself. Hayden was back, she was ready to punch me if she could. “Let me collect my clothes, and we can solve this outside.” Paige was outside too, and Hayden called the police. “He lives here, you cannot just simply evict him whenever you want to, you have to go to the court.” The officers told her. “I am requesting an emergency restrain order on him for Paige.” “Again, you will have to go to court.” I waved goodbye to Paige, and left in Nicklas’s car.

The next day when I came back, Paige was gone. She would spend the rest of the time at Hayden’s place and see me vanish from her life completely by the end of the month. We have never seen or talked to each other since.

“Hi Paige, Nicklas took me in last night and treated me well. I slept well for the first time in a long time, since I didn’t sleep at all on Wednesday, that was refreshing. Chica was anxious in the new environment and was trying to search for Bella and you to cuddle, I gave her some good pets and she slept with me. I am back at our home now, although it is not mine nor a home anymore. We were able to unlock the car and regain access. Two breaking ins did cause some very minor damages to the car though. I am working on some paperworks today and tomorrow to catch the USCIS deadline, so I won’t have time to do much other than that. But after that, I will start to clear the house of my stuff. In the meantime, I will still cook, shower and sleep in the house as if all of these never happened, as if this was still a place that I planned to have a life in. I will continue to collect the mails, to clean the trash and to water your plants, at night I will turn on Dropout to play some videos as background sound. I came to the US 7 years ago with nothing, and I am unable to leave with everything, so things will be left behind when you

come back. Some of them have monetary values, so please feel free to use them or sell them, please also share them with Nicklas as he helped me tremendously over the years, so he is also entitled to any of my tech stuff if he wishes so. Some of them are from precious moments of my life in the US. I looked back these 7 years and nothing was more precious than you to me, I hope you can keep them. My car is yours now, I know you are going through a lot and a new car isn't something you can afford at this moment, I don't have any cash as you know I went through a whole year of financial hardship. This Honda Accord sedan has roughly $15k market value, and I am gifting this car to you as my appreciation, along with any valuables left behind. I had a brief moment of hatred when I was inside my cell looking at the ceiling. I hated you for a brief moment, I hated that you rejected me again and again in the most vulnerable time of my life, I hated that you made my knees weak and couldn't support my burdens standing up, I hated that you secretly took a video of me and got me handcuffed to the hospital. But that was the first time, and will be the last ever, that I hated you. The rest was, is, and will be only love. I never had any thoughts of hurting you, and I promise I won't do stupid things to myself or your house. I am a flawed man, but I do my best to be an honorable man. During this period, I hope you stay safe and enjoy your time with others. Nicklas has done so much for me and he has his own life and pregnant wife that need his attention, so if you are comfortable, please leave a message in our shared GitHub repo. Prior to the end of this month, you should be able to see messages I leave you in that repo, and you should come back home and get back to your normal life. If you need anything to be done by me during this period, please also feel free to leave the message on GitHub or ask Nicklas to relay the message. I will find time to leave so that you can enter the house and do things without my presence, in that case, please give Chica a lot of pets. I love you." That was my last message.

You, the reader of this letter, have helped me tremendously in the hard times of my life. I appreciate you and want to express my gratitude before time runs out. I am writing this letter to share with you these heart breaking moments, to open myself up and be vulnerable in front of you, to give my love and be loved by you without judgement.

I currently do not have a job, I am about to lose my visa and my legal status, I do not know where I can stay overnight, I am about to lose everything in my life, and I am in great fear for the safety of Chica.

But I am still trying. I am taking medications to help me reduce anxiety during sleep. I can get 4, 5 hours of sleep every night now, which is a huge improvement. I force myself to go outside once a day, I talk to some of you every few days, and I have been eating more since October 14. I am reaching out to recruiters, to lawyers, to anyone with a potential job, to anyone with a potential answer. I am reaching out to homeless

shelters, to non profit mental health clinics, to immigration aid services, to animal shelters, to anyone and everyone.

I want to go back to a normal life, here, with you. I want to have a job, I want to have a safe place to stay, I want to have Chica by my side every night, I want to save for a house, I want to settle down, I want to stop worrying about all the visas and legal status one day. You are an important part of my life that I do not want to lose. The harsh reality is, I no longer have a normal life, and I probably never will. If one day I suddenly disappear from your life, please forgive me as I failed.

With my full heart,
Jiawei Wang

Part 3: this part was written after my arrest on October 25th.

Carlos got a new job in Charlotte, much better salary. And he finally moved here to be closer to his family to take care of his mother. I am so happy for him.

I haven't seen Carlos for months, and I was so happy to hear back from him and learn all the good news about his life, about his trip to Peru to meet his father and childhood friends.

It was a sunny Sunday morning, some cold autumn breath. I went to the local tennis park to play with him, and he treated me to brunch after that.

Carlos beat me easily at tennis, as he usually does. The restaurant was full of guests so we went into the neighboring pet market to grab food for his cat and talked about tennis and life in the waiting area. He pulled out his phone to show me the place he is staying at, the new girl he has been seeing, and family photos he received from a French couple he befriended during his years in France.

The sunny-side-up eggs were delicious, so was the ham. I was in a great mood chatting with him. I briefly brought up my breakup but not much detail was given, and I did not mention my hospitalization nor anything else, and I mentioned that I need a place to stay during this transition so maybe he can ask his family about taking in me and my dog temporarily.

Carlos left to take his mom to the church. I took a glance at the receipt on the table, he left a big tip. And I drove back home at 1 pm.

I was overwhelmingly exhausted when I got back, I hadn't been getting much sleep after the hospitalization, I had to take big doses of melatonin to fall asleep, and almost every night I woke up in the middle of the night feeling sweat all over my body.

I had been juggling too many balls at the same time in the past 10 days. After Hayden threatened me inside the house, almost got into altercation with me, called the cops on me for not giving back the key and self evict, and was told by the police she has no legal right but has to go through the court first, she cussed at me and took Paige in at her place on the other side of Rock Hill. No communication ever since. I knew everything was over at that point, so I decided to honor Paige's request and started wrapping up my life here, not just in this house, but in Rock Hill and in the US. I was looking for a place to stay by the end of October, I was getting travel documents for Chica, I was selling and giving away my 7 years worth of personal belongings, I was calling every staffing agency in Charlotte for jobs with visa sponsorship, I was emailing

university professors and hospital HRs asking for IT support roles, I was sending followups for every international positions I applied to but was never formally rejected.

I was calling every friend I still have, asking them to hangout, telling them my time here is near, and how much I love them and how much I will forever remember them.

Prior to that, on Saturday, I went to sleep at 12 and got up at 4 am to drive to Atlanta to take my IELTS exam to support my Canadian Express Entry application, as I was trying everything I could to restart a new life and resume my career. I got back home at 8 pm with hundreds of milligrams of caffeine in my system helping me to not pass out during the 500 miles drive.

Casey told me his students are performing at Rock Hill symphony on Sunday afternoon, and Khang finally finished his parenting break for his new born and with the kid ready for daycare, he is ready to come back to our weekly tennis meetup and eager than ever to play with me in the evening. So I texted Carlos that I want to move our game to early morning, however I spent the whole night staying up to write part 2 of this letter. I got 2 and half hours of sleep.

Exhausted and sweaty, I parked my car in the driveway, and a police officer was there for me. “Sir please step outside of the car, I have a warrant for your arrest.” “What? I don’t understand.” “Your ex-girlfriend has pressed charges on you for petty larceny. You stole her gun.”

Not a single more word, he handcuffed me and put me in another officer’s car, he drove onto a road that I cannot be more familiar with, the road towards downtown Rock Hill, where I had so many meals with Paige in those restaurants, stopped by the pottery center so many times with Paige, and visited the public library so many times for Paige’s book club. The police department is next door, but I did not expect the jail to be there as well.

They took me in and took photos and fingerprints of me. Unlike the incident in Washington in 2022, they were very nice to me. The front desk lady helped me sit down while officer Kong printed out the warrant and read it to me.

“Officer, can I please make a request that you put my key in the mailbox and knock on my neighbor’s door and ask him to take care of my dog for the day?” I asked. He agreed and left. A while later, he came back and handed over me a piece of paper with a phone number on it. “You can call the Chinese embassy in DC and see if they can help you.”

A tall officer handed me some blankets and clothes. He was instructing me on how to use the sink/toilet, how to dial on the phone pad, and he was explaining everything in great detail. He just seems to be a really nice person, so I started to make conversation with him and asked him questions, a lot of questions. “Can I please unlock my phone to get some numbers to call”, “Can you please explain how the fee is charged”, “Can you help me leave a voicemail to my neighbor since my call did not go through” “What should I say to the judge tomorrow if I can’t afford a lawyer” “I am way too overwhelmed and I am very concerned about my dog’s safety, I feel very hopeless.” He was patient and explained everything. He asked me if I want to stay in a shared cell to keep myself safe. I agreed. “I am locked up for a whole day before the release, can I please have a book or something for mental stimulation?” He brought me two, a bible story book titled “Hope”, and a novel titled "Desperate Methods". And I actually spent most of my time talking, and thinking, I didn’t really read much.

The tall officer walked into the cell with me. A young black guy was sleeping while wrapping his body tightly in a blanket to keep him warm. He woke up and started to have conversations with both of us. The officer told him the sink sitting on top of the toilet does not use toilet water, “You see some people are concerned they are drinking toilet water, but actually if you pour the breakfast apple juice down the sink, it will show up in the toilet.” I have some chronic pain issues, so I asked if I could get a pain killer, he went and grabbed a small pouch of ibuprofen, 200 milligrams for one, two in total. “I will need to watch you take it so you can’t keep it.” “I will just take one, 200 mg is already too much for me.” He was amazed how unlike Americans, foreigners usually do not need grams of pain killers. I asked for a towel and toothbrush, he grabbed two toothbrushes to share, they look like sponges on a stick. “Once you start brushing, your saliva will help clean. Don’t think too much about things you can’t control, you are here till tomorrow, you don’t know what will happen to your dog or your properties and you can’t react to it.”

“What is your name sir?” “Officer White.” “You are a good man, Officer White, I appreciate that.”

The cell was quiet, dead quiet, 2 pm on a sunny Sunday afternoon. My young black inmate sat up and started chatting with me, he was very logical. My body was stiff, so I decided to just stand. I started telling my story from the very beginning, how my life was before coming to the US, what I was doing in the past several years before 2026, how I got into a bad visa situation and had Paige by my side to support me, how we got into arguments, and arguments turned into breakup, breakup turned into hospitalization, hospitalization turned into jail. He was listening, listening with his eyes wide open. He rarely interrupted me, but when he did, he was asking questions about what, about why,

about how I was feeling. “I thought I had a life here, and I was punished so unbelievably harshly for things I couldn’t control. I just want a normal life like everyone else. I am not asking anything more.” I cried.

I told him how scared I was, knowing I would be locked up for 20 plus hours. I told him after this very moment of my arrest, my backup plans no longer exist. I could no longer find any job in the US, I could no longer get an apartment, All hopes for Canadian work authorization were gone, and I would never, ever be approved for any American visa or green card forever. “It’s the end of the road.”

He started praying to God, he started praying how grateful he is for the blessings he received, how thankful he is for having the willpower to push forward, how bright he sees his future to be. He started telling me pieces of his story, how his father passed away early in his life, how his mom couldn’t support him so he became homeless on the streets, how he made mistakes when he was 17 and has been working relentlessly through probation. He told me he did not know he violated some rules and had a warrant issued by the probation officer. Well, I did not know I had one either. How the officer said he felt sorry to arrest him when he was on his way to attend church. How he was not eligible for shelters and had to spend most of the money he earned from washing cars on hotels.

He told me a lot about his struggles, but he also told me so much about his life plans. He sees so many people his age getting comfortable staying in jails for free meals and “a roof over head”, he hates that. He wants to apply to that $19 hourly job at Ross he has been thinking of, he wants to continue washing cars, to save more money so he can afford longer stay at hotels, and he wants to get his driver license, buy a car, go to college, and he wants to take his girlfriend out for nice things, and eventually he wants to buy a house and start a family.

“How much are you paying for hotels everyday?” I asked. “$65 right now, and I can make $100 a day, sometimes more.” “Have you heard about extended stay? If you ask for a weekly rate, it will be much cheaper, you should be able to get something under $300 a week, even better than some apartments here.” He was shocked. He did not know that.

I started telling him a lot about housing, cars, personal finance, and many others. “We just met a few hours ago, but I see you as a great person, you are strong, you have great willpower, and your faith is incredible. When I was 20, all I did were attending classes, writing homeworks and playing video games. You are going through so much more than me and you are too mature for your age.” I shared my learning with him on

many different topics, how he should make plans for savings, take small steps, build credits, make small investments, secure credit cards and loans, and go to community college then transfer to university to save money. I also shared a lot of my personal experience and my opinions, how I dislike consumerism, how credit cards help rich people save while making necessities inaccessible for the poor, how this society rewards capital but not labor, how lower social classes are punished for minor mistakes and suffer long lasting consequences.

My inmate gave me lots of motivation, he kept telling me tomorrow we would both be bonded out, he would collect his stuff from the hotel and go straight to Ross and get the job, while I would find a new place to stay and make millions again with a new job. He kept telling me God has a plan for everyone and God takes good care of everyone. He did not know what the harsh reality with immigration is in the US, he did not know I already lost everything, and the door was not only shut on me, but reopened and shut in my face again.

Dinner time, I asked officer White what time it was. “5:30” “I am having anxiety over claustrophobia, can I go out for a minute or two?” “Sorry, you can’t leave after 5 and you can’t make a phone call anymore.” He waved at me and left.

A microwave dinner in a plastic container, with two slices of bread. Young inmate peeled the cover and started devouring. I ate the bread and left the container untouched.

Nothing happened at night, some new people were sent here, but luckily not into our cell. I did not want a crazy DUI driver or drug addict ruining our conversation. There was a thick cover on the ceiling that let partial sunlight go though, I looked up, it was pitch black. “Khang probably is playing at the meetup and wondering why I didn’t show up.” I told myself. Night shifts came, and I had nothing to ask them for so I just sat there, in my blanket, talking to my inmate, about all kinds of things. I was mostly sharing with him my past lessons and mistakes while he was giving me encouragement. “I said when you were sent here that I want to keep you safe, if that means I have to stay up all night with you, I will stay up. I am listening.” I cried, he was too good of a man.

He got up to brush his teeth. “You can taste the toothpaste, it’s in the sponge.” He was amazed and excited, then he went to bed. “Good night.” he said. “Good night to you too, I truly believe you will achieve great things in life and please promise me starting tomorrow, you will go get that job and get a safe place to stay.” “I promise.”

I started flipping through the two books, my eyes struggled to stay open, I put the books under the inflated mattress to raise it up a little bit so I could have a pillow to rest my

head on. Some noises from other cells followed by chats from the officers, I covered my face with the blanket and curled up my body so both my head and feet could be covered and the light above the toilet could be less annoying. If I can guess, I would guess I slept for 6 hours that night. New record.

Morning came, a microwave hot pocket and an apple juice. I drank the juice. My inmate was refreshed, he started telling me he felt good about seeing the judge today and more about his family and girlfriend. My depression was getting worse, so I was walking back and forth in the cell, I was staring at the hallway from the window, and I let him do the talk.

“The beginning of the book is never the same as the ending.” “Always be grateful today because tomorrow is never promised.” Two things he said to me stuck in my head.

I was let out to see the judge through a video call, the judge gave me information about my court date and logistics, and asked for my statement. I told her how everything happened, how bad the situation was for me, and how I was trying my best to pull myself up and ready to leave, and how this arrest once again destroyed the tiny remaining of all my hopes. She did not interrupt and let me finish everything. Paige was not in the room with the judge, but there was a lady representing her, I assumed she was the prosecutor or victim advocate. She read through the alleged crime, asked the judge to grant a no contact order, and the judge granted it. The judge gave me a $2,000 bond amount, I had no idea if that is a lot or not.

I went into the holding room and started dialing numbers on the bondsman list. The 5th call went through, Mr. Jennings picked it up. I was expecting him to be the most insufferable person and extremely rude to me, but he was not. He asked my name, bond amount, and friends’ numbers to pay the initial fee, and instructed me to get the paper work and wait for him as he “need to put more money in my account to keep the call going and I am already on my way to bail you out, once I am here, you will be out in 15 minutes.”

The day shift officer handed me some papers, I asked her some more time to read before signing. She saw I was struggling so she let me out and explained them one paper after another. She overheard my statements to the judge and asked me what happened, and I told her the story that I told everyone, just a slightly shorter version with different details emitted. “I am just so overwhelmed and I can not imagine the future anymore.” She handed over a box of tissues to me to wipe my tears. “You don’t have any family here?” “Not a single one.” “Oh, I am so sorry.”

Mr. Jennings called back, “Nicklas paid the fee,” he said, “he also told me about your situation, I am really sorry. Your friend is a really good person.”

I went back into my cell and sat for another hour there, I already said everything I wanted to say to my inmate so I just sat there. He was talking about how he would forever remember all the things I told him last night and promised me he would “only do good from now on.”

A tall officer unlocked the cell, “You are bailed out.” I stood up and hugged my inmate, I held him tight and said to his ear that I wanted both of us to forever remember this day and I appreciate him so much and I trust him will do everything he can to have a bright future. “They will let you see a judge very soon and you will get good news. Years later, when you become successful, please don’t forget that night this Asian guy believed in you.” “I promise I won’t.” Tears blurred my vision once again. My glass was too dirty to be cleaned with shirt again, so I wiped the lens with my finger. I never asked him his name, he never asked mine either.

I got my stuff back, the sweaty shorts and my tennis shoes. I went outside, Mr. Jennings was there, he was waving and smiling. I walked towards him and shook his hand, and we went through the paperworks. Clear Path Bail Bonds, not a bad name for a company.

I left the building, it was noon, no one to take me home this time so I just walked. I walked past the library, the restaurants, the churches and houses, and I was by the local university. College kids in their late 10s and early 20s were passing me, they were carrying textbooks, talking on the phone about family thanksgiving plans, holding lunch, skateboarding, listening to music. I was sad.

My home, no, there is no home. My legal residence appeared in front of me. The door was locked, Chica was barking inside, I looked into the mailbox, the key was not there anymore. I remember Officer White told me to get an escort last night, so I called the Rock Hill PD. Officer Walker came, I told him what happened, he went back into his car to look through the files, then he came back and told me Paige talked on the phone and told him she took the key last night but there is a spare key. I said “have a nice day officer” and went inside. I took a shower and ate the leftovers I was eating for the past two days, and I sat down to start writing part 3 of this letter. I called my public defender, she told me she would talk to the warrant officer this weekend to sort things out. Nicklas texted me “Your bondsman is convinced you are a good guy.” Two hours passed, officer Walker knocked on the door. “Bad news, Paige said she wants to move back today so you have to leave.” “But she said she wanted me to leave by the end of this month and I

am already going through it.” “Sorry, she changed her mind.” “So what am I gonna do?” “Pack your essentials, and get a hotel tonight. If you want to retrieve your property next time, call us to escort you.”

I went to grab backpacks and suitcases and started dumping clothes and toiletries into them. I put Chica on a leash and gently pet her and told her I am sorry and we no longer have a place to stay. She tilted her head in confusion.

It took me a while to pack things I needed so officer Walker waited patiently, he asked me what our relationship before the breakup was like, I shared nothing but positive memories. “So the breakup, hospitalization, warrant, arrest, no contact order, all of these connect together to become the eviction today.”

He walked me out of the house and locked the door. “You can’t make a phone call here, you have to start driving first, go to a park or something, there is a nice one down the road, go there and call hotels and figure out where you want to stay tonight, but you can’t stay here.”

Stuff all over my car, I started driving. 5 pm on a Monday afternoon, the traffic was bad. I called Nicklas, “Sorry I would help but my wife is firm on this so I can’t argue with her”. He helped me so much and I could not appreciate him more. I called Carlos, went into voicemail. I called Kevin, “What’s up Jiawei!” “I just went through a lot of things and I want to have dinner with you.” “Sure, I will wait for you at the restaurant we went to last time.”

Sunny Monday afternoon, everyone was trying to go home to be with their family, to have dinner and to enjoy their evening. I was trying my hardest not seeing the collapse of my life in my head. Chica was whining on the passenger seat, so I gave her lots of pets.

Kevin was there in his shorts, talking on the phone, he is always helping everyone sort out their lives. I tied Chica on my chair and ordered a burger. I told Kevin what happened, and he laughed it off. “It’s not that serious, you will be fine.” He is just a person that does not let anything ruin his day. “I don’t get it why you are always so happy, your truck broke down and has been stuck at the dealership for weeks in the middle of nowhere.” “I am flying there tomorrow to pick it up, I have an air mattress you can sleep on.” I did not even ask him for help.

The sun went down and it was too cold to eat outside so I packed my food and asked for the check. He helped carry all my stuff into his apartment and set up the mattress. I

offered to drive him to the airport. He went outside to grab a beer. I tried to type something on the computer but was too tired so I went to sleep. Chica jumped onto the mattress and glued her body onto mine, I had a good sleep.

I do not really feel anything anymore. I was on my way to leave the house and leave Rock Hill forever later this week. I was trying so hard to get everything back together. I was thinking about how my life would be different if I did not argue with Paige in September, or if she just had a tiny amount of empathy and accepted my apologies, if she did not say “my feelings towards you are gone and they are never coming back.” I would absolutely be willing to overstay on my visa, I would work in restaurants getting paid under the table, I would empty all my retirement to pay for the bills, I would risk my safety if ICE came. I was ready to risk it all, even the night before my arrest.

“It feels like you kicked your ball onto the road, so you went to grab it, and you got run over by a truck.” I said this to Paige several weeks ago when I was opening myself up to her.

Life punished me harshly, unreasonably harshly.

After this arrest, all my hopes to rebuild my life anywhere are gone. Kevin came back three days later and I lost the last safe place to stay. I am already accumulating credit card debt to feed myself and put gas in the car. I am thinking about surrendering Chica so at least she won’t have to suffer with me anymore. Any path towards employment, or legal status, any possible future life in the US is gone, never will I ever receive another visa to visit this country, and in the meantime I am forced to stay here for my trial but I will not survive till the end of December to attend the court hearing. My dream for Canada is gone too, I am a criminal in all the systems now, like a branded cattle on a farm. It has been weeks and I have not heard back from any recruiter for my applications to Chinese companies. My life is over.

I miss my family. I miss my friends. I want to play tennis once again.

Unemployment killed me, immigration killed me, Paige killed me.

My final wishes are:

1. Chica is given to any of my friends listed on this letter excluding my parents. $2,000 will be given to any one of the mentioned friends that is willing to adopt Chica, to compensate for the expenses of veterinarian visit, vaccination, flea/tick/heartworm prescription, and other expenses. If no one is willing, she will be surrendered to a no-kill shelter.
2. All my properties are properly retrieved from Paige's house, anything containing personal data is handed to my parents and anything without is given to Nicklas.
3. My car is liquidated and the balance is used to pay off my debts, including my credit card debts, medical bills and bond.
4. My judgement in Massachusetts is properly collected.
5. After the car is liquidated and judgement is collected, from my remaining balance, Nicklas will receive $5,000 as a gift, Kevin $3,000 and Nathan, Casey, Todd, Vlad will each receive $1,000. Carlos and Khang each $500.
6. Every individual mentioned in this letter will receive a full copy of it.
7. My investments and retirements are properly transferred to my parents.
8. My ash is handed to my parents and they will bury me next to my grandfather.
9. Paige Meinke gets nothing.

Jiawei Wang

My belongings are:

1. At Paige's house: 1028 College Ave Ext, Rock Hill SC
2. At Nicklas's house: 1516 Cedar Tree Dr, Belmont NC
3. At Kevin's apartment: 8728 Matthews Farm Ln, Unit 10313, Charlotte NC
4. At the motel: 10930 Park Rd, Room 133, Charlotte NC

To contact:

1. Carlos Barreda: 704-962-4054
2. Casey Mink: 803-325-4047
3. Kevin Melkonyan: 702-338-2646
4. Khang Pham: 225-244-3582
5. Nathan Klinge: 919-257-0606
6. Nicklas Jensen: 980-701-1780
7. Paige Meinke: 864-704-7259
8. Todd Hardy: 240-644-9366
9. Vladimir Gerasik: 803-306-0813
10. Wang Wenqiu / Gao Jinhua: +86-139-6666-7792 / +86-139-0551-8421
11. Wu Yong: wechat xzhoone
12. Wang Yingying: wechat wyy006004
13. Wang Shaohua: wechat wsh583073045
14. Niu Zihao: wechat daniulaoniu
15. Lei Dameng: wechat leidameng001
16. Somerville MA District Court: 617-666-8000

To view this letter:

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2. Github: https://github.com/Jiawei-Wang/the-day-i-met-paige